

Foreword

We live in a digital world, and computers are part of almost everything we do. Not so long ago, computers were bulky, noisy machines that lived mainly on desks, but now they are tiny, silent devices hidden inside our phones, cars, TVs, and even watches. We use them to work, play games, watch films, go shopping, and keep in touch with our friends and family.

Today's computers are so simple to use that anyone can operate them. But not so many people know how to write the code that makes them work. Becoming a coder allows you to look under the bonnet and see how a computer really works. With a bit of practice, you can build your own apps, write your own games, or just tinker with other people's programs and customize your own ingenious creations.

As well as being an addictive hobby, coding is a skill that's in huge demand all over the world. Learn how to code and it will set you in good stead wherever your life leads, whether you're interested in science, art, music, sport, or business.

Today, there are hundreds of coding languages you can learn, from simple, drag-and-drop languages like Scratch™ to web-programming languages like JavaScript®. This book is based on Python®, one of the world's most widely used coding languages. Equally popular with students and professionals, Python is easy to pick up yet powerful and versatile. It's a great language to learn whether you're a beginner or moving up from a simple language like Scratch.